Paris Travel Guide - France

Overview

Paris, the capital of France, is renowned for its art, fashion, gastronomy and culture. It is one of the most visited cities in the world, attracting travelers with landmarks such as the Eiffel Tower, the Louvre Museum and Notre-Dame Cathedral.

Best Time to Visit

The best time to visit Paris is between April and June or September and November when the weather is mild and crowds are smaller. Summer (July-August) is peak tourist season with warm weather averaging 20-25 C. Winter is cold, averaging 3-7 C, with occasional rain.

Top Attractions

Eiffel Tower - iconic iron tower offering panoramic views of the city.

Louvre Museum - the world's largest art museum, home to the Mona Lisa.

Notre-Dame Cathedral - Gothic cathedral on the Ile de la Cite.

Montmartre and Sacre-Coeur Basilica - historic hilltop district with artist studios.

Champs-Elysees and Arc de Triomphe - famous avenue and triumphal arch.

Local Transportation

The Paris Metro is the fastest way to move around the city, with 16 lines covering most tourist areas. A Navigo weekly pass or carnet of tickets is recommended for tourists. Buses and the RER regional trains connect to the airports.

Estimated Daily Budget

Budget travelers: approximately 70-90 USD per day including hostel stay, metro pass and street food. Mid-range travelers: 150-220 USD per day for a 3-star hotel, restaurant meals and paid attractions. Luxury travelers: 350 USD and above per day.

Travel Guidelines

A Schengen visa is required for most non-EU visitors. Tap water is safe to drink. Tipping is not mandatory but rounding up the bill is appreciated. Many museums are closed on Mondays.